

FAST-TRACKING THE AGRI ECONOMY

- (Top right) **Ajay Vir Jakhar**, Chairman, Bharat Krishak Samaj
- **Ashok Gulati**, Distinguished Professor, ICRIER

» Gulati spoke on the impact of politically controlling food prices over allowing price volatility

» In a session titled 'Path To Kisaan Kalyan', Gulati said: "The additional funds for the PM-Kisan scheme are a step in the right direction, but may not be enough to address the sector's needs." He added that rural youth are leaving agriculture for low-paid, urban jobs

due to stagnating income growth in agriculture

» Echoing Gulati's concerns, Jakhar emphasised the need for systemic reforms beyond financial aid, including improving market access, managing input costs, and promoting crop diversification

» Jakhar criticised food price caps on onions and wheat, which disadvantage farmers



FEELING THE POLITICAL PULSE OF THE BUDGET

- (From left) **Rajdeep Sardesai**, Consulting Editor, India Today Television
- **Gourav Vallabh**, Professor of Finance & Leader, Bharatiya Janata Party
- **Krishna Prasad Tenneti**, MP, Telugu Desam Party
- **Salman Soz**, National Spokesperson and Senior Leader, Indian National Congress
- **Sushmita Dev**, MP & National Spokesperson, All India Trinamool Congress

» Lauding the Union Budget, Vallabh said it is not about political outcome but economic outcome. "This Budget is purely focussed on employment, improving the quality of employment, focussing on the manufacturing and services sector," he said

» TDP's Tenneti said it's difficult to separate politics from economics. "The Interim Budget in February was economical but not political." He added that some Congress-

led states have failed to deliver on their pre-poll promises

» Meanwhile, Sushmita Dev, of the Trinamool Congress said she doesn't blame Bihar and Andhra Pradesh for asking for incentives

» Critiquing the Budget, Salman Soz said India will require at least 180 million jobs to reach the global average. He added that the focus of the government should be on climate finance and energy instead of the states of Andhra Pradesh and Bihar

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